

AMERICAN RED CROSS CENTRAL AND SOUTH TEXAS

Campaign Book by



Boiling Point

The Lab at The University of
Texas at Austin

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

BRAND

The American Red Cross Central and South Texas Region serves 83 counties, home to over 9.4 million people. For centuries, the American Red Cross has utilized volunteers in every corner of the region to provide hope and comfort to their neighbors in crisis. The Red Cross urges communities to prepare for, respond to, and recover from emergencies large and small. The services that the American Red Cross offers include disaster relief and preparedness, lifesaving CPR and first aid training, international family tracing, and support for military, veterans, and their families. The Central Texas chapter serves people facing emergencies every day, embracing the diversity of staff, volunteers, and people they serve.

AUDIENCE

The primary audience for the American Red Cross is the Deaf and Hard of Hearing (DHH) community. These individuals include hearing people engaged in the cause, Sign Language Interpreters and translators, and friends and other relatives.

STRATEGY

The goal of our strategy is to develop a relationship between the American Red Cross and the Deaf and Hard-of-Hearing community while raising awareness for the resources and volunteer opportunities the Red Cross has to offer. The tone of our messaging will focus on the empowerment of the DHH community over the “help” we can provide for them.

AGENCY INTRODUCTION



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SITUATIONAL ANALYSIS

STRENGTHS

The Red Cross depends on donations of time and money, limiting its budget for large-scale innovations and regional marketing. Its success is reliant on community support. People might not know about the five main service areas, which could make them think their skills wouldn't be useful to the Red Cross.



WEAKNESSES

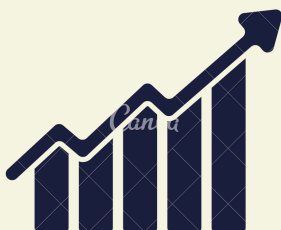
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OPPORTUNITIES

Leverage the UT American Red Cross club to engage students and recruit passionate individuals while using social media for recruitment, public trust, and circulating information.

Actively diversify volunteers for better community service and form partnerships to boost visibility, trust, and support, leading to increased donations and volunteers.



THREATS

People in need of Red Cross services may hesitate to seek help, potentially missing out on valuable assistance. Competition from other non-profit organizations sharing similar focuses can dilute the spread of crucial messages, donor support, and volunteer engagement, while some niche-focused non-profits may better resonate with specific demographics.



COMPARING INDUSTRY PLAYERS

SALVATION ARMY

Christian organization that provides diverse social services such as:

holiday giving, food pantries, disaster relief, and homelessness assistance

Location

Serves in 134 counties, 4 being in Central TX

Targets

Communities and partners, spiritual seekers, young adults, families/individuals in need



Similarities

Commitment to serving their communities through volunteerism and trust-based relationships

Differences

Offers social services, addiction rehabilitation, and spiritual support that is rooted in its Christian denomination

COMPARING INDUSTRY PLAYERS

AUSTIN DISASTER RELIEF NETWORK

Austin-based nonprofit aiding disaster-affected individuals and families through coordinated disaster response, survivor care, training, and preparedness plan

Location

Comprised of nearly 200 trained network of churches in and around the Greater Austin Community

Targets

Survivors impacted by disasters

Similarities

Service offerings are in the same five main areas as Red Cross Central Texas.

Differences

Christian-led and exclusively serves the Austin area



COMPARING INDUSTRY PLAYERS

CATHOLIC CHARITIES OF CENTRAL TEXAS

Non-profit organization that offers support services such as:

disaster response, counseling services, financial stability, and immigration legal services

Location

All 25 counties of their service region in central Texas

Targets

Anyone in need in the Austin Community

Similarities

Prioritize humanitarian aid & reliant on volunteers for community service

Differences

Guided by Catholic values & provides long-term support emphasizing social services



CAMPAIGN OBJECTIVES



Enhance **accessibility, inclusivity**, and **preparedness** for the DHH community during emergencies and disasters



Create formal **announcements, social media campaigns, press release** and possible **press conference**



Increase **volunteer workforce** to provide for DHH services and programs

CAMPAIGN CHALLENGES

As we were researching the American Red Cross, we found it difficult to find information about resources like the bed shakers and fire alarms. We assume that if someone did not know what they were looking for, they would not be able to acquire these resources. To make resources more **accessible** for the DHH community, we must make the website easier to navigate.

The DHH community is not familiar with the resources the American Red Cross has to offer. Through our research, we found that the relationship between the American Red Cross and the DHH community has great potential to become stronger. We must **bridge the gap** and make connections with the community to better serve this demographic.

Establishing **trust and visibility** within the DHH community poses a challenge. These individuals typically look for resources from other organizations other than the Red Cross. Making the services and offerings visible and available allows for increased engagement and connection with the DHH community.

RESEARCH

We sent out a survey to 137 of our family and friends, and there were some results that stood out.

93.4% of our respondents are more likely to volunteer with a friend or family member

27% of our respondents either know or partially know ASL

50.4% of our respondents say that being “unfamiliar with a cause” would deter them from volunteering with an organization

Regarding brand awareness, we did find evidence on social media that suggested a lack of accessible information and the lack of ASL interpreters. There was also a need for volunteer opportunities for the Deaf community.

Lack of ASL interpreters



CLBDA @ChicagolandBDA
X | US | May 18, 2023 · 12:29 PM



Why knowingly come to a **deaf** person's home to install specialized smoke sectors for the **deaf** without an ASL interpreter? 🙄 @RedCross

deaf, @RedCross

Need for volunteer opportunities



#OurDeafCommunity: Austin

Erika Chirino · Feb 17 · 🌐

Hello Beautiful Austin Community,

Does anyone know any volunteer opportunities for the Deaf community?

Thank you 🙏

Lack of accessible information

“I did a lot of research and eventually found... out that Red Cross in the U.S. will brin a free bed shaker and inspect the home for fire safety.”

via redddit user 5 months ago



TARGET AUDIENCE RESEARCH

With the goal to strengthen the resilience of the 68,000 deaf and hard of hearing (DHH) residents in Austin, American Red Cross will increase awareness of essential services offered and learn more about this community to offer the best services. In our research we found that:

The DHH community is made up of people who identify as deaf or hard-of-hearing, but it doesn't stop there. Hearing people engaged with the cause, Sign Language interpreters and translators, CODAs, friends and other relatives are also included in this group. (www.handtalk.com). Additionally, One out of 20 people are deaf or hard of hearing according to Survey of Income and Program Participation (SIPP)

Being hard of hearing is a spectrum

Perspective: Average decibel reading for normal conversation is ~60db

Hearing loss is identified at losses greater than 40db

Mild hearing loss: Hearing loss of 20 to 40db

Moderate hearing loss: Hearing loss of 41 to 60db

Severe hearing loss: Hearing loss of 61 to 80db

Profound hearing loss or deafness: Hearing loss of more than 81db

There is a difference between being Deaf and deaf. Deaf individuals are individuals who were born deaf and are culturally engaged with the Deaf community. Individuals that are deaf individuals may not have a strong connection to the Deaf community and their deafness is perceived as an impairment.



INSIGHTS

In addition to the research that we compiled on the DHH community and attitudes toward volunteering, we wanted to get a better perspective from members of the community. This allowed us to be more empathetic and cautious with the way we approached the DHH community, avoiding any miscommunication. A member of our PR team interviewed with members of the UT Deaf Culture Alliance and found key insights that laid the foundation to our campaign.

Messaging is Key



We found that the DHH community wants information to be clear and easy to access. This could mean updating the website to make DHH community resources easier to navigate or meeting members of the DHH community through events and collaborations held by fellow DHH community allies. One respondent mentioned that they will likely skip over info if it doesn't meet the standard of accessibility (signing will catch the eye). This means all resources and copies put on advertisements need to be easily accessible and inclusive to the DHH community.

There is Power in Numbers



DHH individuals want to support their community. One respondent said, "If one Deaf person is there, meh, if two Deaf people are there, interesting, if three Deaf people are there, okay what's this all about?" This means, that to increase the number of members in the DHH community that use American Red Cross resources, there needs to be multiple volunteers that are also a part of the community. This could mean including people who are fluent in ASL, are deaf themselves, or are family and friends of deaf people

Empower vs. Help



We found the DHH community is more likely to respond to messaging that avoids using language like "help" or "helping". Members of the DHH community do not want to be pushed to feel like victims. The American Red Cross should instead provide access to resources and support to the community. Additionally, these resources should not be forced on them, but rather something that is available to those in need. This identity holds to the Red Cross' mission to prepare individuals for disasters while also serving as a supportive member of the community.

TARGET AUDIENCE

The primary audience for the American Red Cross is the Deaf and Hard of Hearing (DHH) community. These individuals include hearing people engaged in the cause, Sign Language Interpreters and translators, and friends and other relatives. With 1 in 20 people being deaf or hard of hearing, our predominant focus is the DHH individuals who are seeking emergency technology to navigate natural disasters. Our secondary priority is the friends and family members of DHH individuals because this audience is an integral part that affects the lives of the DHH community. Our last and tertiary focus is American Sign Language interpreters. All of these audiences are connected by the technology, accessibility, and resources the American Red Cross offers. We further developed our target audience by creating three personas that best represent the individuals we are trying to connect with:



Home Alone Harry

DHH Individual
Age: 75
Retired Professor

Harry lives alone and identifies as “deaf” due to recent hearing loss. His daughter comes over frequently and assists him. Harry wants to be more prepared in case of an emergency since he lives alone. Harry also feels frustrated with the difficulty of finding life-saving information and resources given his age and condition.

Harry is at the center of our target audience because he is a DHH individual that will benefit the most from the ALD services the Red Cross can provide.



Involved Irene

DHH Individual
Age: 19
Student at the University of Texas

Irene is a member of the Deaf Culture Alliance Club. She identifies as “Deaf.” Irene uses Instagram to find and share most of her information. She is more likely to engage in content that meets the standard of accessibility for the Deaf community. Irene will likely share ALD resource information to her Instagram.

Irene is at the center of our target audience because she will share the resources that the Red Cross offers to the DHH community.



Friend Franny

Friend or family member
Age: 35
HEB cashier

Franny works alongside her friend who is Deaf. She actively seeks out resources to educate herself and feels it’s important to support the DHH community. Franny is easygoing and open minded about learning and trying new things.

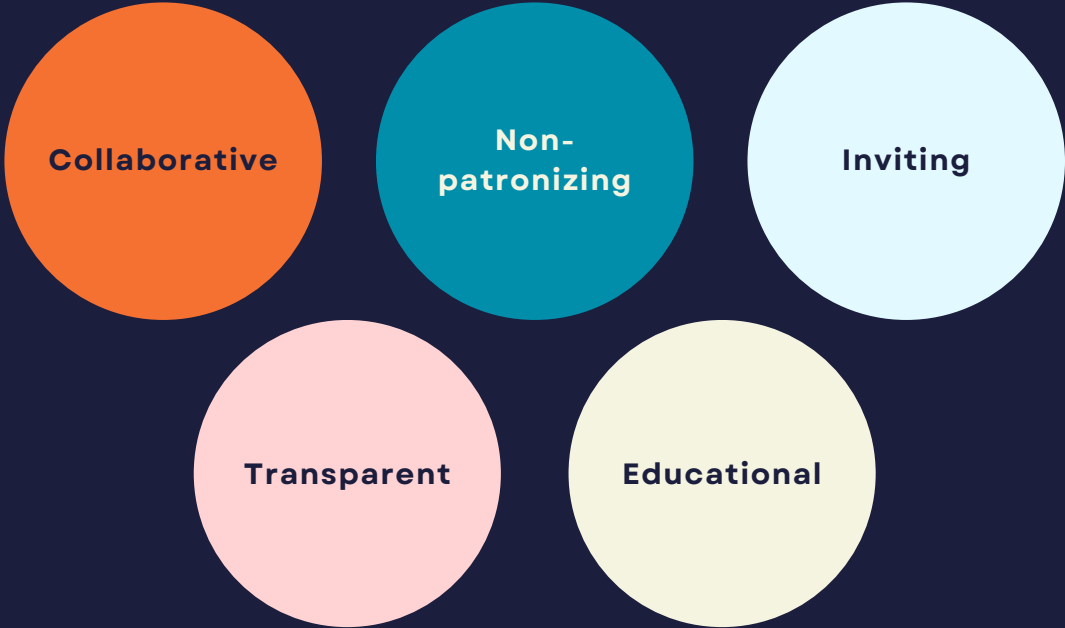
Even though Frannie is not at the center of our target audience, connecting with her will be crucial in order to increase the Red Cross’s volunteer force and raise awareness for its resources.

COMMUNICATION STRATEGY: *OPEN ARMS*

Based on the research that we conducted, we discovered that there is a need to tread carefully in the way we approach the DHH community. It is important to communicate in a manner that is perceived as approachable. In order for the Red Cross to be an effective asset and partner with the community, they first need to establish a relationship to foster a sense of trust. Beyond that, the DHH community will also view the Red Cross as a safe, empowering, and dependable place to confide in.

Our activations will address our communication strategy by first introducing a collaboration between the Deaf Culture Alliance Social Club and the American Red Cross to build a stronger relationship with the DHH community before promoting resources. We want the DHH community to get comfortable with the American Red Cross and see the relationship as mutualistic.

The idea of “Open Arms” communicates that the American Red Cross has the right resources for the DHH community if they need them. The keyword here is “if” because the DHH community might not want or need the Red Cross’s services. We want to focus our strategy on the empowerment of the DHH community versus pushing the help we can provide for them. Ultimately, we want the Red Cross to become a place that the DHH community can trust not only for ALD resources, but for a philanthropic environment that is trustworthy and empowering. The tone of our messaging will be:



Collaborative

**Non-
patronizing**

Inviting

Transparent

Educational

ASL MINOR STUDENT VOLUNTEER OPPORTUNITIES

Send out flyers in early September to UT staff in time for fall volunteering events (Sign the Alarm events)

- **Opportunities:**
 - Red Cross gaining new volunteers
 - UT students completing volunteer requirements for degree plan
- **Contacts:**
 - **Linguistics Department** within the College of Liberal Arts
 - linguisticsreception@austin.utexas.edu
 - **Ann Huff Stevens** - Dean of the College of Liberal Arts
 - ann.stevens@austin.utexas.edu
 - **Corrine Occhino** - Faculty Member of Linguistics Department
 - occhino@austin.utexas.edu
 - Has agreed to share volunteer opportunities



UT DEAF CULTURE ALLIANCE CLUB COLLABORATION

Deaf Culture Alliance's mission is to bring together Deaf students, Hard-of-Hearing students, and students with a passion for ASL and Deaf Culture. They host ASL socials, work on projects together, have discussions about Deaf Rights and education, and are actively making positive changes in the community.

Why a collaboration would be beneficial for the Red Cross:

- Builds credibility within the Deaf community
- Deaf people and ASL users are more likely to attend ARC events/volunteering
- Establish a relationship that benefits both organizations to reach individual and shared goals
- Reaches a wider audience since the Red Cross and DCA target different people



Contact: deafculturealliance@gmail.com

NATIONAL DEAF AWARENESS MONTH EVENT

Event in partnership with Crepe Crazy to celebrate
National Deaf Awareness Month

Where: American Red Cross facility in Austin, TX

2218 Pershing Dr, Austin, TX 78723

When: Sunday, September 29th (National Deaf Awareness Day)

What: An opportunity to foster the relationship between the Red Cross and Crepe Crazy, as well as the greater Austin Deaf and Hard-of-Hearing community. Taking place on National Deaf Awareness Day, this social event aims to encourage the growing conversation between the DHH community and hearing individuals. The Red Cross is dedicated to learning more about the DHH community and invites community members to join them in celebrating the month.



Crepe of the Month:

- To further grow relationship with Crepe Crazy
- Red Cross inspired crepe in October for National Fire Prevention Month
- Featured in-store

\$1,000 Total Budget:

- Non-sponsored food truck total
 - \$14 per crepe, 20% service fee, \$20 local travel fee
 - \$500 minimum, excluding sales tax
 - = **\$620 total** (35 crepes plus 20% service and travel fee)
- Non-profit donation request forms
 - [HEB Community Investment Program](#)
 - [Austin FC Donation Request](#)
 - [Tito's Vodka Donation Request](#)
 - [AT&T Funding Request](#)



MEDIA OUTREACH

Reporters with previous Deaf-related news coverage

Name	Outlet	Email
John Diaz	KVUE	jdiaz@kvue.com
Morgan McGrath	KVUE	mmcgrath@kvue.com
Kelsey Thompson	KXAN	kelsey.thompson@kxan.com
Daniel Gravois	KXAN	daniel.gravois@kxan.com



Sample Media Advisory



American Red Cross
Serving Central Texas

The American Red Cross of Central Texas to Celebrate National Deaf Awareness Month with Crepe Crazy

WHO: The American Red Cross of Central Texas and Crepe Crazy.

WHAT: The Red Cross of Central Texas is hosting an event to honor National Deaf Awareness Month. Crepe Crazy, a Deaf-owned and operated business, will be on-site to provide delicious crepes to event attendees.

WHEN: Sunday, September 29th (Time TBD)

WHERE: 2218 Pershing Dr, Austin, TX 78723

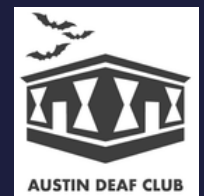
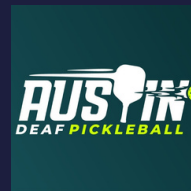
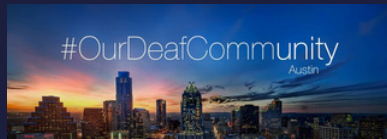
WHY: An opportunity to foster the relationship between the Red Cross and Crepe Crazy, as well as the greater Austin Deaf and Hard-of-Hearing community. Taking place on National Deaf Awareness Day, this social event aims to encourage the growing conversation between the DHH community and hearing individuals. The Red Cross is dedicated to learning more about the DHH community and invites community members to join them in celebrating the month.

CONTACT: Delia Krippelz, Regional Communications Director, delia.krippelz@redcross.org

LOW VS. HIGH BARRIER ENTRY ORGANIZATIONS

LOW BARRIER

HIGH BARRIER



Some places are focused on bridging the gap between Deaf people and hearing people. However, there are some places that are only a space for Deaf people to exist and maintain their culture and structure.

We concluded that Deaf Artisan Market Day and Crepe Crazy have the lowest entry barrier as anyone can enjoy this without being a part of the community. FaceBook groups allow anyone to join or post and are open to outside resources so they are also a low entry barrier.

Then we have the Deaf Austin Theatre, The School for the Deaf and Austin Deaf Club which, based on our research, we decided these organizations have a high entry barrier because they are less open to outside resources, lack public information, are difficult to contact, and will likely need an inside referral to get in touch.

Post Template

Calling all members of *(insert organization here)* in Austin!
Volunteer Opportunity Alert!

The **American Red Cross of Central Texas** seeks volunteers fluent in **American Sign Language**. Join the Red Cross to volunteer as an interpreter to serve those in our community who rely on ASL for communication.

Interested in becoming a volunteer? Get started here!
<https://www.redcross.org/local/texas/central-and-south-texas/volunteer.html>



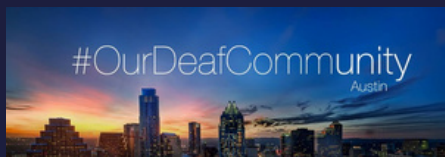
ASL Run Club



Austin Deaf Pickleball



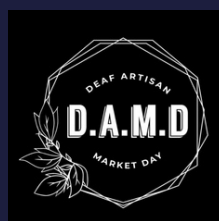
DEAFOPIA



#OurDeafCommunity



Deaf night out



Deaf Artisan Market Day

SIGN OF THE DAY

In honor of the **deaf awareness month** in September, the American Red Cross will launch a social activation called **Sign of the Day**. This activation will feature a word in ASL each day on American Red Cross's TikTok, Facebook, and Instagram stories. This aims to not only foster a favorable brand image to the deaf and hard of hearing community but to also bring awareness to American Red Cross's fire safety resources for the DHH community.

A different word(s) will be posted everyday, 5 days a week for 4 weeks. The social media stories will show a video of an ASL-fluent individual signing and thoroughly explaining the word(s), accompanied by hand-drawn animations. Each week will have a different topic that the words will follow. To start off September with general ASL terms, week one will be **Essential Phrases**, and week 2 will be **Introduction and Small Talk**.

As we move onto the last two weeks of Sign of the Day in October, the topics will shift to be more related to American Red Cross's services. Week 3 will feature words related to **General Safety**, and finally week 4 will feature words related to **Fire Safety**. Below is a table of all the words that will be featured on American Red Cross's social media stories.



[LINK TO EXAMPLE POST
AND IN DEPTH OF WORDS
BY WEEK](#)

Week 1: Essential Phrases

Mon: Hello & Goodbye
Tues: Please & Thank you
Wed: Yes & No
Thurs: Sorry & Excuse me
Fri: Good morning & Good night

Week 2: Introduction and small talk

Mon: What's your name? & My name is...
Tues: Nice to meet you
Wed: How are you? & I'm good
Thurs: Where are you from? & I'm from...
Fri: I like... & I don't like...

Week 3: General Safety

Mon: I need help & Do you need help?
Tues: Call 911
Wed: Where are you hurt? I'm hurt
Thurs: Be careful
Fri: Emergency

Week 4: Fire Safety

Mon: Fire & Smoke
Tues: It's hot, don't touch that
Wed: Fire extinguisher
Thurs: Evacuate
Fri: American Red Cross

Deaf Culture Alliance Collab: OFFICER HIGHLIGHTS

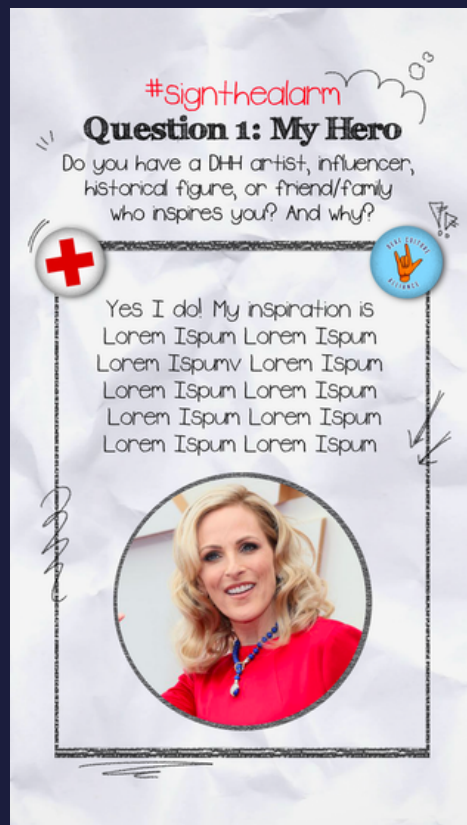
The primary objective of this activation is to enhance collaboration between the American Red Cross and the Deaf Community Alliance (DCA), focusing on highlighting and celebrating the unique contributions of DCA officers. Each officer highlight post will share their cultural perspectives or their experiences with the Red Cross.

These answers will initially be shared by the officers on their personal Instagram stories and then reposted on the official Central Red Cross Instagram page. Over the course of four weeks, 1-2 officers will be featured weekly. This strategy aims to foster greater connection with the DHH community and continue in raising awareness for the Sign of the Alarm Campaign.

The American Red Cross will send out a form to the Deaf Culture Alliance (DCA) to highlight their officers to learn more about the deaf and hard-of-hearing community. The goal is to establish a stronger bond with the DHH community and raise awareness for the **Sign the Alarm Campaign**. This campaign revolves around providing the DHH community with information about ASL home fire safety resources, free bed shakers, and encouraging the DHH community members to volunteer for the American Red Cross.

This form presents the DCA officers questions to share their stories for American Red Cross. Your answers will help celebrate the diversity of the DHH community!

Form ---> <https://forms.gle/WHLU92ryP1Ctptjp6>



WEBSITE ACCESSIBILITY

Old user Flow: ARC homepage > Get Help > How To Prepare for Emergency> Fire safety button > Explore ASL Resources

New User Flow: ARC homepage> Accessibility > Deaf / HH

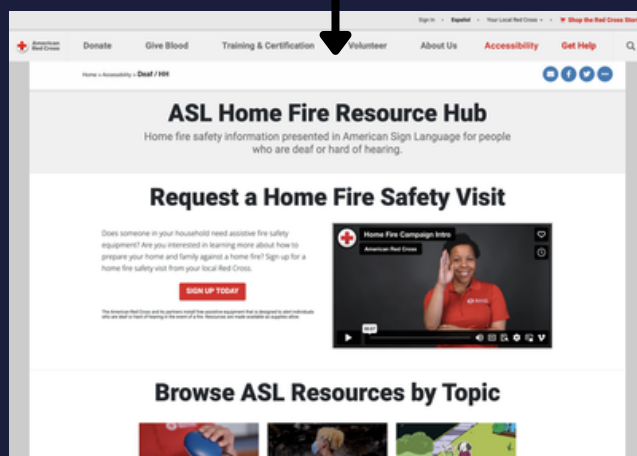


1. Addition of an “Accessibility” tab to make information relevant to the DHH community easier to find.

Ad space is available to highlight the campaign #SignTheAlarm



2. Under the new “Accessibility” tab lives the new “Deaf/HH” sub-tab that houses relevant information already present under Red Cross’ ASL Home Fire Resource Hub.



3. After user clicks Deaf / HH tab, users will be led to ARC’s ASL Home Fire Resource Hub.

Three Part Animated Social Spots

In this series, we meet Steve, Granny, and Jenny, each facing a common yet overlooked hazard: being Deaf or Hard of Hearing during a fire emergency.

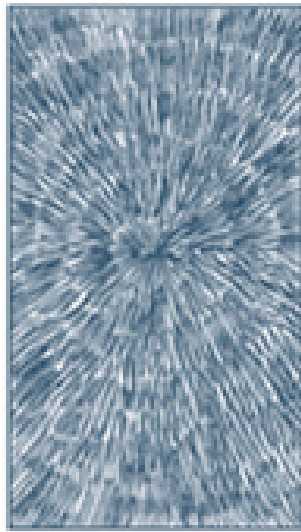
Each story shows us that a regular fire alarm isn't enough when you can't rely on hearing, and without a consistent alarm system such as a bed shaker alarm, one is instead relying on chance and others to wake up during such an emergency. By touching on the innate fear of loss, the message becomes more urgent and clear.

These short 30-second spots will be shared on Instagram Reels and TikTok as sponsored posts, ending with a direct call to action that leads to the Red Cross bed shaker alarm request page. The aim is to convey that requesting a bed shaker alarm is an easy decision for anyone with hearing difficulties.

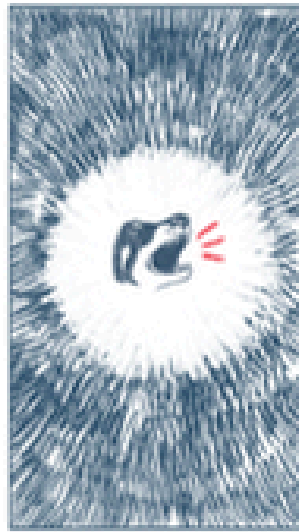


**Animated social spot:
DOG**

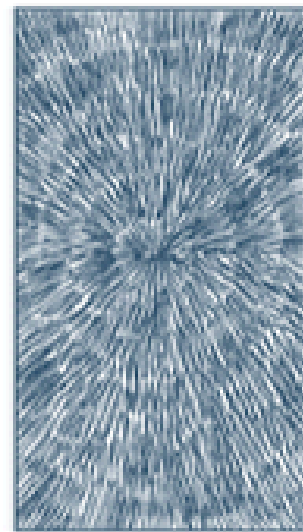
Animation Storyboard: DOG



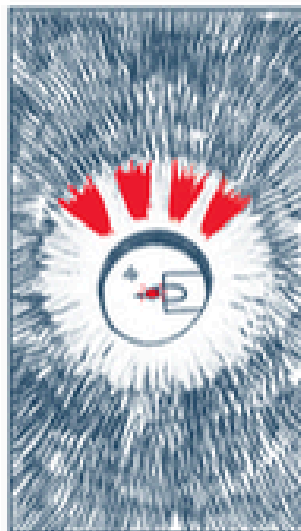
DARK SCRIBBLES
APPEAR ON SCREEN



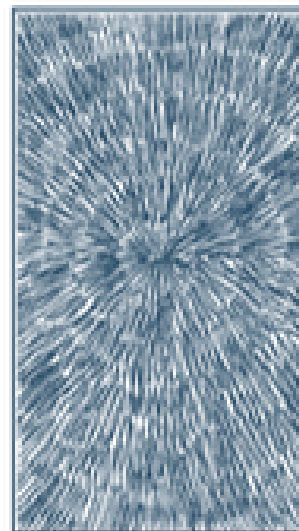
DOG'S MOUTH BARKING
APPEARS WITH MUFFLED
BARKING SOUND



DARK SCRIBBLES
REAPPEAR ON SCREEN



FIRE ALARM WITH RED,
FLASHING LIGHT APPEARS,
WITH A MUFFLED BEEP



DARK SCRIBBLES
REAPPEAR ON SCREEN



DOG'S MOUTH BARKING
APPEARS WITH MUFFLED
BARKING SOUND

The scene opens with darkness and silence, setting a tense atmosphere. Suddenly, a dog with its mouth open appears, its barking muffled, flashing on the screen momentarily. Darkness takes over once more, only to be interrupted by a flashing fire alarm with its beeping muffled. Silence and darkness return, then are cut through by the image of the dog, now barking with greater urgency, yet still muffled. This scene alludes to someone coming in and out of sleep, getting only small pieces of information.

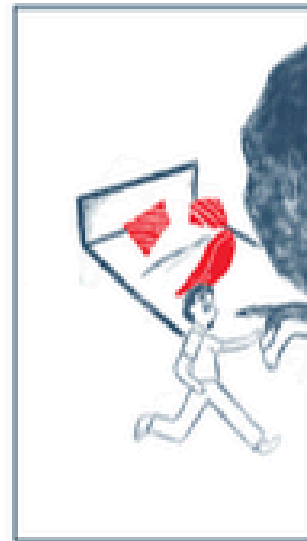
Animation Storyboard: DOG



DOG IS BARKING AT
STEVE, SLEEPING IN BED
TRYING TO WAKE HIM



STEVE IS NOW SITTING UP
IN BED AWAKENED BY DOG,
REALIZING THERE'S A FIRE.



STEVE AND DOG ARE
RUNNING OUT OF THE ROOM.

YOUR DOG WAITS FOR YOU.
WHAT ARE YOU WAITING FOR?

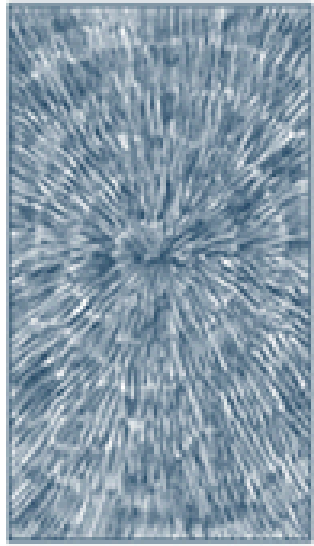
SWITCH TO A BED SHAKER

#SIGNTHEALARM

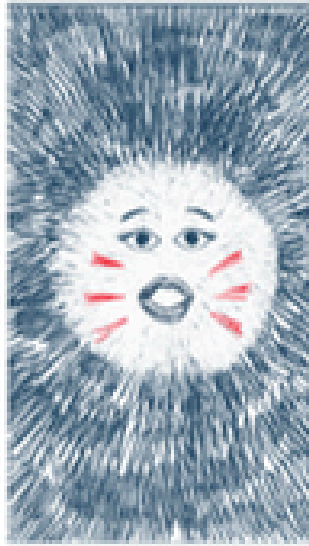


The setting shifts to a bedroom where Steve, who is hard of hearing and his dog who is trying to wake him up due to a fire occurring in the house. Steve is unable to hear his dog barking or the fire alarm due to being hard of hearing and is only able to get to safety because of his dog. This spot is trying to convey the necessity of fire safety, in this case, it is having a fire alarm that alerts you immediately. The dog is there to tug at the viewer's heartstring by showing that the dog is willing to wait for Steve regardless of the danger, and that to avoid putting their loved pet in danger they should stop waiting and get a bed shaker alarm.

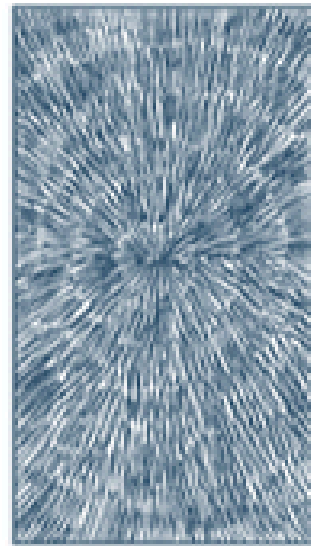
Animation Storyboard: GRANNY



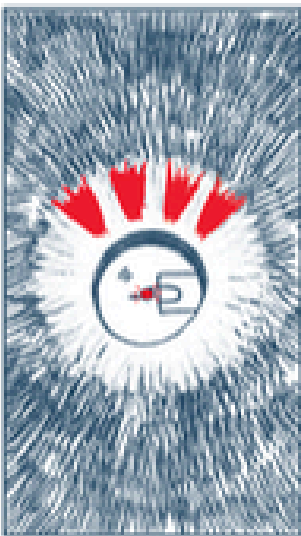
DARK SCRIBBLES
APPEAR ON SCREEN



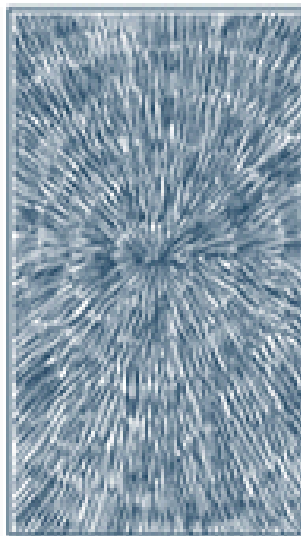
FACE MOUTHING THE
WORDS "WAKE UP"
APPEARS ON SCREEN



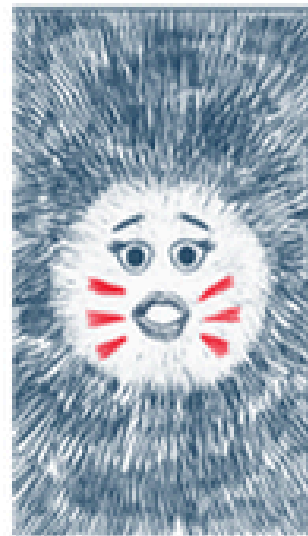
DARK SCRIBBLES
REAPPEAR ON SCREEN



FIRE ALARM WITH RED,
FLASHING LIGHT APPEARS,
WITH A MUFFLED BEEP



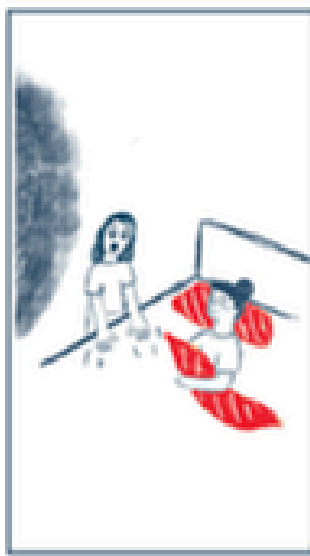
DARK SCRIBBLES
REAPPEAR ON SCREEN



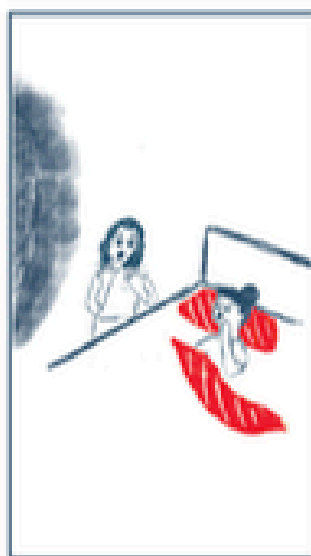
FACE MOUTHING THE
WORDS "WAKE UP" REAPPEARS
ON SCREEN URGENTLY

The scene unfolds similar to the "Dog" spot, in darkness and silence. Abruptly, a face materializes, articulating "wake up" in a muffled voice. This brief plea is soon shrouded by darkness once again, which is swiftly cut by the urgent glow of a fire alarm's red light, its sound muffled. The darkness engulfs the scene again, only to be disrupted as the face re-emerges, mouthing "wake up" this time a louder, but still muffled. This echoes the earlier spot's theme of awakening, here featuring Jane as she tries to rouse Granny.

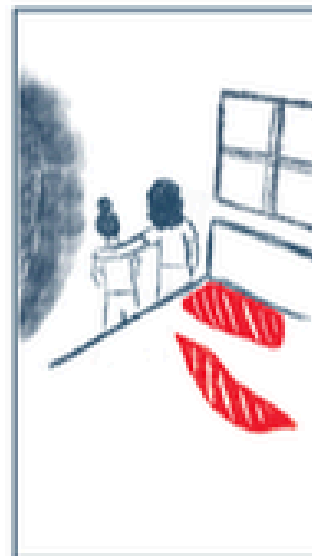
Animation Storyboard: GRANNY



GRANNY IS LYING IN BED,
STILL UNAWARE OF THE
DANGER. JANE SHAKES THE
BED TO WAKE GRANNY



GRANNY IS NOW AWAKE,
SHOCKED BY THE FIRE



GRANNY IS NOW
LEAVING THE ROOM,
ACCOMPANIED BY JANE

WHEN YOU'RE ASLEEP,
SO IS YOUR SENSE OF SMELL

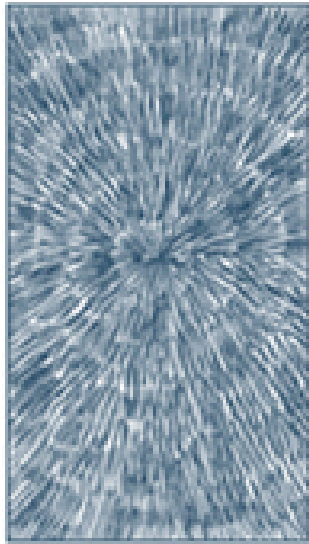
SWITCH TO A BED SHAKER

#SIGNTHEALARM



The spot then moves to a bedroom where Granny, an elderly woman with hearing loss, sleeps, oblivious to the fire alarm and the danger it signals. Her granddaughter, Jane, works to awaken her, shaking Granny's bed and using sign language to stress the gravity of the situation. The essence of this narrative is the danger of depending solely on the sense of smell for fire detection, which is both perilous and ineffective. It informs the viewer about life-saving devices like bed shaker alarms, essential for those who cannot rely on conventional auditory alerts.

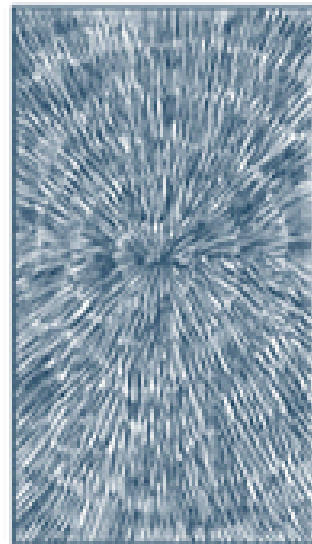
Animation Storyboard: BEDSHAKER



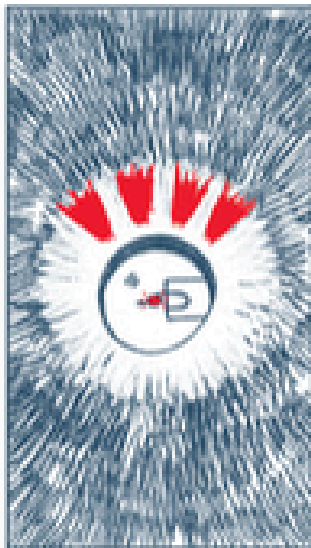
DARK SCRIBBLES
APPEAR ON SCREEN



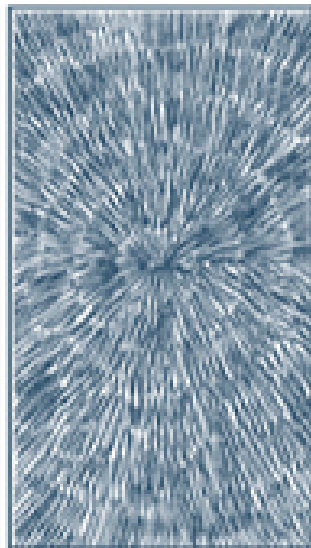
"WAKE UP" IN SIGN FLASHES
ALONG WITH TEXT



DARK SCRIBBLES
REAPPEAR ON SCREEN



FIRE ALARM WITH RED,
FLASHING LIGHT APPEARS,
WITH A MUFFLED BEEP



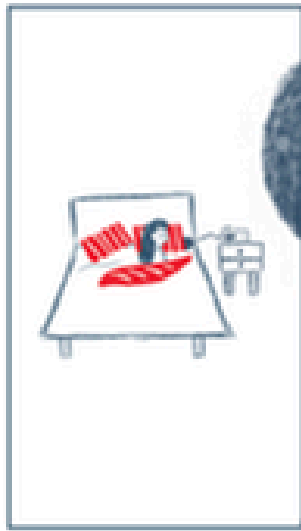
DARK SCRIBBLES
REAPPEAR ON SCREEN



"WAKE UP" IN SIGN FLASHES
ALONG WITH TEXT AGAIN

Like the previous spots, this one begins in darkness before revealing the text "WAKE UP" accompanied by its sign language gesture. The darkness soon envelops the screen again, only to be pierced by the red flash of a fire alarm and its muted beep. As darkness returns, the urgent "WAKE UP" in sign and text reappears, flashing as a critical call to action.

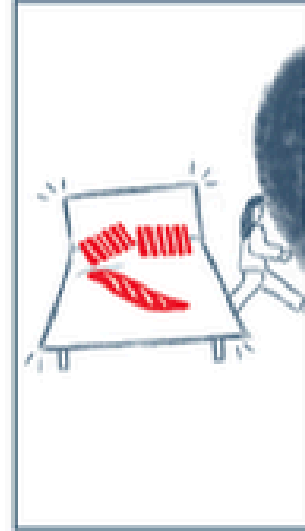
Animation Storyboard: BEDSHAKER



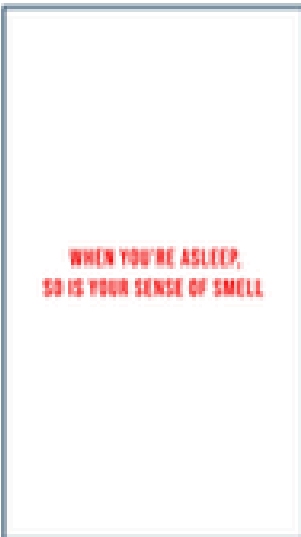
JENNY IS LYING IN BED, ASLEEP WITH THE BED-SHAKER ATTACHED TO THE BED, UNAWARE OF THE DANGER



A CLOSE-UP SHOT OF THE BED-SHAKER, EMPHASIZING THE MOVEMENT



JENNY IS NOW OUT OF BED, EXITING THE ROOM QUICKLY



WHEN YOU'RE ASLEEP,
SO IS YOUR SENSE OF SMELL



SWITCH TO A BED-SHAKER

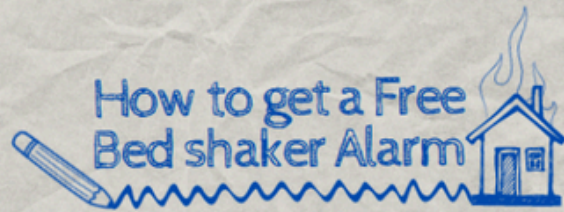


#SIGNTHEALARM



It transitions to a bedroom where Jenny, a person who is deaf, is sleeping soundly while a fire breaks out in her house. Unaware of the danger due to her inability to hear the fire alarm, she is abruptly awakened when her bed shaker is activated. The vibrations provide the sole indication of the fire, prompting Jenny to quickly grasp the situation and swiftly move to safety. The spot aims to highlight that for someone who cannot hear, the absence of an appropriate alarm like a bed shaker is as risky as not having an alarm at all. The viewer is left with a compelling call to action—to equip their homes with bed shaker alarms to ensure safety in the event of a fire.

Free Bed Shaker Infographic



How to get a Free Bed shaker Alarm

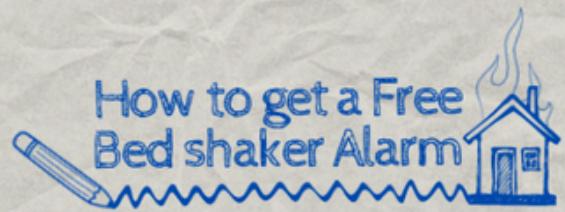
STEP 1: FILL OUT THE FORM

Visit the Linktree in our bio to request home fire safety equipment for people who are deaf and hard of hearing

.....



#SignTheAlarm



How to get a Free Bed shaker Alarm

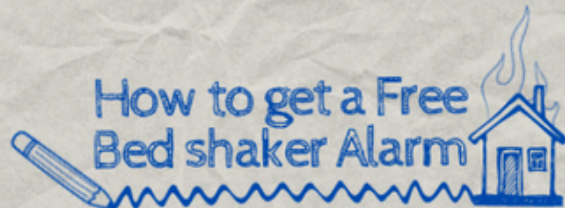
STEP 2: WAIT FOR A RESPONSE

We will reach out to you for a home fire safety visit



.....

#SignTheAlarm



How to get a Free Bed shaker Alarm

STEP 3: SCHEDULE AND INSTALL

Our members will come to your home to install any necessary fire safety equipment

.....



#SignTheAlarm



STEP 4: CHECK ALARM MONTHLY

After 10 years, alarm sensors are weak so please contact us again for a replacement.

To read more about home fire safety click the Linktree in our bio!



#SignTheAlarm

Through a carefully curated carousel post, we aim to spotlight our shared commitment to serving the DHH community while raising awareness about essential services. Significantly, #SignTheAlarm is a major aspect of this social media activation and works hand in hand with our other social series. Accessing these resources is made seamless via the Linktree integration in both account bios. "How to get a Free Bed Shaker alarm" is an insightful post delivering valuable information and reinforcing ARC's dedication to inclusive support.

Deaf Culture Alliance Resource Spotlight Instagram Collaboration



CAPTION:

“#SignTheAlarm

We have partnered up with the American Red Cross to share these available resources, including home fire safety, specifically for the DHH community. Visit the Linktree linked in our bio to learn more.”

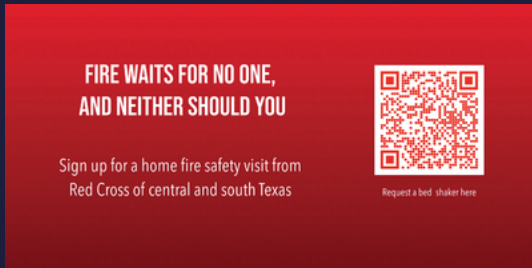
This Resource Spotlight will be posted on Instagram using the collaboration feature in order to be posted on both the Deaf Culture Alliance and the Central Texas American Red Cross feeds simultaneously. This carousel post will help maintain the relationship between the DHH community and the American Red Cross as well as bring awareness to the services offered. These services will be easily accessed via the Linktree in both account’s bios.

For the testimonials, home fire survival stories were grabbed from the American Red Cross website. For the DCA testimonials, members of the organization will provide their own - that is, in the case that any of them have encountered home fire safety first-hand or their experience [possibly volunteering with] American Red Cross.



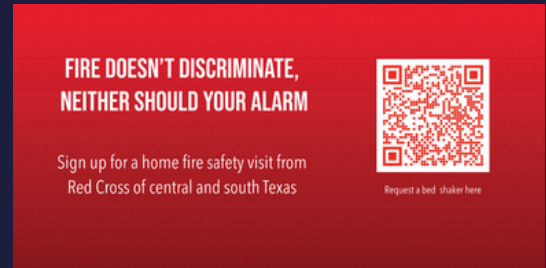
BUSINESS CARDS

Back Version 1



Call to Action & QR code that leads to ARC
Bed- Shaker form

Back Version 2



Call to Action & QR code that leads to ARC
Bed- Shaker form

Front For All Business Cards



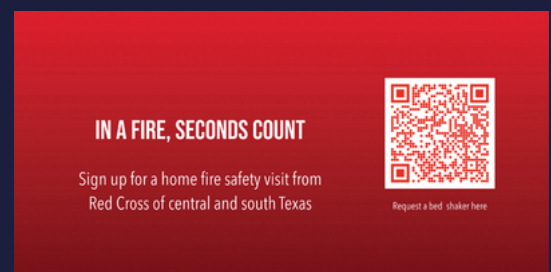
SignTheAlarm campaign highlighted,
ARC, and ASL in sign

Back Version 3



Call to Action & QR code that leads to ARC
Bed- Shaker form

Back Version 4

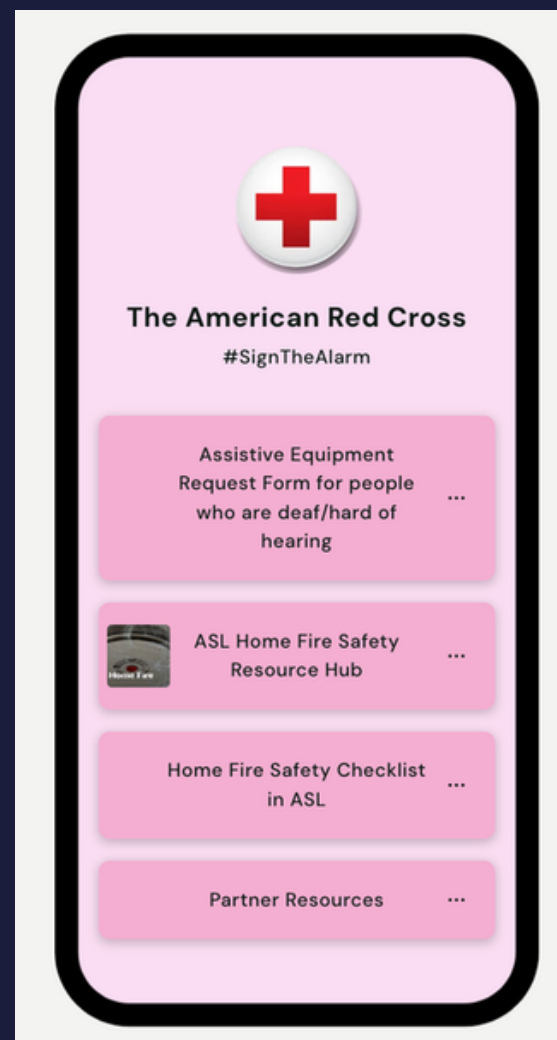
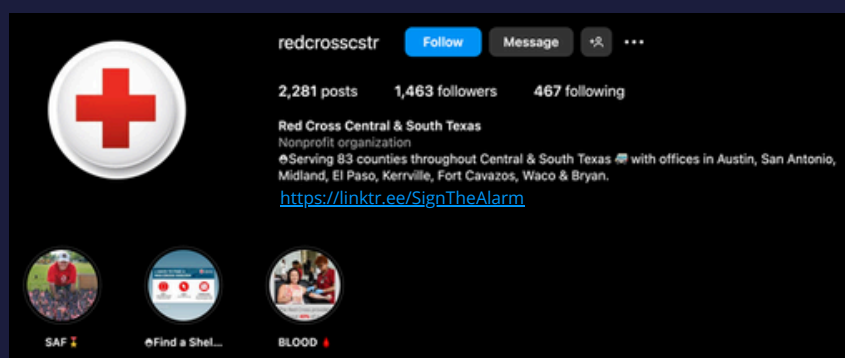


Call to Action & QR code that leads to ARC
Bed- Shaker form

Social Media Linktree

In order to make the online resources more accessible to our audience, a **Linktree** will be linked in the bio for all American Red Cross's social media platforms during the duration of the campaign. This Linktree will contain links that lead to requesting bed shakers, the American Red Cross's ASL website, a home fire safety checklist, and information about volunteering.

Most of our social media activations will call our audience to click the Linktree in our bio for more information about fire safety resources for the deaf and hard of hearing community. The Linktree is linked [here](#).

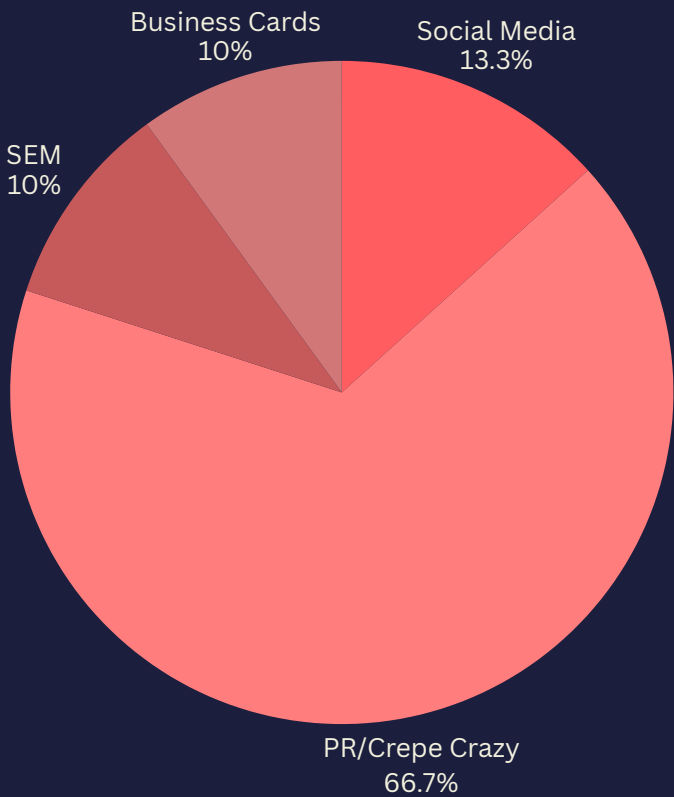


[Google drive](#)
to all
activation
assets



MEDIA STRATEGY

Our media department decided to utilize four different forms of media to execute our strategy. We focused our strategy on boosting social media posts on Facebook and Instagram, creating business cards for ARC, SEM (search engine marketing), and PR’s partnership with Crepe Crazy.



We decided to execute this campaign over the course of 3 months: September, October, and November. We chose these months because there are significant events that occur during these months that are very prevalent to increasing awareness with our target audience.

Channels	Sept. 2024 (Deaf Awareness Month)	Oct. 2024 (Fire Prevention Month)	Nov. 2024	Total Spending (NET)
Boosting Social (Facebook/Instagram)	\$40	\$80	\$80	\$200
PR Events (Partnerships)	\$800	\$100	\$100	\$1000
SEM/Paid Search	\$50	\$50	\$50	\$150
Business Cards	\$50	\$50	\$50	\$150
Monthly Total	\$940	\$280	\$280	\$1,500

SEM & KEYWORDS

For the SEM implementation, our team chose these four keywords that we believe fit well with our campaign and ARC's goals to increase awareness about their resources and increase the number of volunteers they currently have. There are endless amounts of other keywords and keyword combinations ARC could utilize, these are just a few that correlate well with our campaign.

Note: We did not include "bed shakers" in this list because our research indicated that people in Austin and its surrounding areas do not search for that term on Google as often as we would like.

Keywords	Bid Range
"Deaf fire alarm"	\$0.46 - 9.78
"Deaf smoke alarm"	\$0.46-9.78
"Places to volunteer near me"	\$0.13 - 10.50
"Learn American sign language"	\$0.49 - 2.78

MEASURING SUCCESS

To measure the success of our various media channels we decided that these KPIs should be the ones we should focus on:

- Boosting Social - Impressions & Engagements (TBD)
- PR Events - Attendance & Hashtag Usage (TBD)
- Clicks (TBD)
- Numbers of Cards we print/distribute

There are measurements labeled as TBD because there are no current benchmarks set for these metrics.

To get the campaign started, our media team doesn't recommend spending a lot of money on boosting social or SEM at the very beginning. We recommend spending money slowly for these channels so that you may grow to understand your return on investment from impressions, engagements, and clicks.

For boosting social media posts, we recommend spending about \$15-25 dollars per post to learn how it impacts engagement. This means you'd have low, consistent investment levels until you gather enough data to justify spending more on boosting.

For SEM, we recommend spending \$25-50 a month, for all of the keywords combined, and the budget that's leftover can be redistributed to the channels that are doing well.

CAMPAIGN CALENDAR

To kick off our campaign, we've strategically chosen September, which coincides with National Deaf Awareness Month. This significant month will mark the debut of our first animation (DOG). Alongside this, we'll be implementing a Search Engine Marketing (SEM) initiative. Building on this momentum, we'll launch our "Sign of The Day" Instagram campaign, leading to the Crepe Crazy Event and the introduction of the Crepe of the Month at various locations.

In October, we will monitor and optimize our Search Engine Marketing efforts. Our "Sign of The Day" Instagram campaign will run throughout the first half of the month, five days a week. October also encompasses Fire Prevention Week, we'll actively engage with Facebook groups, promoting our bed shakers through compelling messaging and infographics. Additionally, we will be kickstarting the collaboration between Red Cross Central Texas and the Deaf Culture Alliance (DCA).

Starting with our third and final animation, November will focus on the collaboration between Red Cross Central & South Texas and the Deaf Culture Alliance (DCA). This partnership will feature highlights spotlighting DCA officers. Additionally, we will actively post and promote resources within targeted Facebook groups.

September 2024



Sunday	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
1 POST DOG ANIMATION	2 Implement SEM	3 FILM FB VIDEOS W ASL DESCRIPTION	4	5	6 →	7 FINALIZE FB GROUP POSTS
8 FINALIZE FB GROUP POSTS	9	10 POST IN FB GROUPS ABOUT EVENT	11	12	13	14
15	16 SOTD INSTA	17 POST IN FB GROUPS ABOUT EVENT SOTD INSTA	18 SOTD INSTA	19 SOTD INSTA	20 SOTD INSTA	21
22 POST IN FB GROUPS ABOUT EVENT	23 SOTD INSTA	24 SOTD INSTA	25 SOTD INSTA	26 POST IN FB GROUPS ABOUT EVENT SOTD INSTA	27 SOTD INSTA	28 POST IN FB GROUPS ABOUT EVENT
29 CREPE CRAZY EVENT ★	30 SOTD INSTA					

CAMPAIGN CALENDAR: OCTOBER & NOVEMBER

October 2024



Sunday	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
CREPE OF THE MONTH @ C.C.		1 Monitor/Edit SEM <i>SOTD INSTA</i>	2 <i>SOTD INSTA</i>	3 <i>SOTD INSTA</i>	4 <i>SOTD INSTA</i>	5
6 FIRE PREVENTION WEEK ★	7 POST GRANNY ANIMATION: <i>SOTD INSTA</i>	8 <i>SOTD INSTA</i>	9 <i>SOTD INSTA</i>	10 <i>SOTD INSTA</i> POST IN FB GROUPS	11 <i>SOTD INSTA</i>	12
13	14 POST BED SHAKER INFOGRAPHIC	15	16	17	18	19 DCA Volunteer Collab
20	21	22	23	24	25	26
27	28	29	30			

November 2024



Sunday	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
Reminder: Monitor SEM/Edit					1 POST BED SHAKER ANIMATION ★	2
3	4 DCA Officer Highlight (President)	5 POST IN FB GROUPS	6	7	8	9
10	11 DCA Officer Highlight (Two officers)	12	13	14	15	16
17	18 DCA Officer Highlight (Two officers)	19	20	21	22	23
24	25 DCA Officer Highlight (Two Officers)	26	27	28	29	30